Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear European student Alba Ortega talking about going to university in New Zealand. For questions 1-10, complete the sentences (with 1 to 3 words).

Alba decided to go to New Zealand because her

1/ _____ had studied there.

One reason Alba chose Christchurch was that she could go

2/ _____ when she was there.

Alba likes the fact that the 3/ _____ is quite different from that in her home country.

At first she found it difficult to call some people by their

4/ _____

She is impressed by the fact that most of the staff write

5/ _____

She believes she is now a lot better at 6/ _____ than she was.

After she graduates, Alba intends to 7/ _____ in Christchurch.

When she first came to New Zealand, Alba was surprised by the distance from

8/ _____

Her summer holidays start on 9/ _____

In December, Alba hopes to see 10/ _____ when she goes away.

Some vocabulary: HIGHER EDUCATION

Complete the text with these words:

academic	Bachelor's	graduate	lectures	Master's	postgraduate
qualify	secondary	seminars	thesis	tutor	undergraduates

The higher education systems in some English-speaking countries such as the UK, Australia and New Zealand are similar in some ways. Pupils at (1) _____ school take examinations at the age of 18, and those who (2) _____ for university then usually begin their (3) _____ degree courses, which normally last three or four years. At this stage students are known as (4) _____, and they learn about their subject by attending (5) _____ in large groups. These are often followed by discussion in (6) _____, involving a much smaller group of students and a (7) _____ who asks questions and encourages them to talk about the topic. When they successfully finish their first degree, students (8) _____ and may then go on to do a (9) _____ course such as a (10) _____ degree. For most students, the highest (11) _____ achievement is to obtain a doctoral degree by writing a (12) _____ based on research.

Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read an article in which four people talk about their careers. For questions 1-10, choose from the people (A-D). The people may be chosen more than once.

TIP…
You don't have to begin by reading the whole text. You may find it helpful to read the questions first, then scan each part of the text.

Which person…

- did not go to university? 1/….
- has heard the company might be bought by a bigger organisation? 2/….
- was pleasantly surprised by the working conditions? 3/….
- says that enthusiasm and determination will bring great success for the employee? 4/….
- found it difficult at first to complete work on time? 5/….
- is confident they will be able to carry out their extra duties? 6/….
- says the way they are paid makes financial planning simpler? 7/….
- liked their job as soon as they started it? 8/….
- had to understand a lot of new things very quickly? 9/….
- is unsure exactly how much they will earn in the future? 10/….

1 _____
2 _____
3 _____
4 _____
5 _____
6 _____
7 _____
8 _____
9 _____
10 _____

Training for the future

Four young trainees talk about their jobs.

A) Jessica

After leaving school, I had a gap year working in Africa before I did my medical degree. I'm now a Junior Doctor in training at a local hospital, where the work is demanding but very rewarding with lots of advice and support from senior colleagues. Before I started here I'd expected to have to work very long hours, but nowadays there's a maximum of 48 hours per week for doctors. There is of course shift work, but the days of junior doctors having to live in and be on call all night are, I was happy to find, long gone. There's also a clearly laid-down salary structure in this profession, and that makes it easier to think ahead - for instance if you're intending to take out a loan for house purchase, you know roughly what you'll be able to afford.

B) Stefan

I'm a Trainee Financial Advisor with a leading Financial Services firm. I came here after I graduated in Economics and took to the work straightaway. Once I've finished my training, I'll be working with an established team of specialist advisors. That will mean taking on a lot of added responsibilities such as building lasting business relationships with clients, but I'm sure I'll manage. And although the basic salary is possibly a little below average, from next year there will also be a few extras such as fully paid holidays in Miami and a car allowance, as well as a company lunch every month at one of the best restaurants in town. If, like me, you're highly motivated, in this firm your career can really take off.

C) Arantxa

I graduated last year and shortly afterwards I was taken on here as a Graduate Engineer. Unlike some of my colleagues I didn't have any work experience and the tasks I was given were quite varied, so there was a tremendous amount to take in all at once. And in those early days I had a little trouble meeting deadlines, though as I gained experience, I quickly got over that. From next autumn I'll become a buyer for the firm, purchasing imported goods and equipment, which means I'll control a fairly large budget. That's going to be quite a challenge. At present I'm keen to remain here at this branch, though that may be affected if the rumours that a major corporation is considering taking the firm over turn out to be true.

D) Matthew

I would like to have studied Law at university but I didn't have the grades, so I went straight from school into a law firm. I spent two years there, and then took up my current post in Local Government as a Trainee Legal Assistant. It's interesting work, with lots of variety within the field of planning law. I have particular responsibility for public transport, for instance giving legal advice on any new schemes or proposed changes in the bus, tram or suburban rail networks. That means doing a lot of research, so a basic requirement of the job is the ability to work on one's own, rather than as part of a group. The salary here is reasonable, although in the present economic climate, with such huge cuts to public spending, that may not be the case for much longer. Still, I feel it's a worthwhile job, and fairly secure, too.

Word formation

For questions 1-8, read the text below. Use the word given in capitals at the end of some of the lines to form a word that fits in the gap in the same line. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Jobs for graduates

Although most graduates find (O) .... ***EMPLOYMENT***... within a year of leaving university, and their (1) _____ tend to be substantially higher than those of non-graduates, the rates vary from subject to subject.	EMPLOY EARN
Recently, (2) _____ carried out a survey of over 200,000 graduates who stated their (3) _____ for work and found that nearly all those with degrees in medicine and dentistry had jobs twelve months after graduating.	RESEARCH AVAILABLE
Education comes next in the list, showing that a teaching (4) _____ usually leads pretty quickly to a job, followed by law. For those looking for work as (5) _____ , the prospects aren't quite so bright, especially in the physical sciences .	QUALIFY SCIENCE
It's a similar story for business and administrative studies, though many graduates find positions in junior (6) _____ in large organisations, while others become trainee (7) _____ in smaller firms. People with degrees in technology do less well, with quite a few (8) _____ still unemployed.	MANAGE CONSULT ENGINE

Writing – formal letter of application

Quick steps to write a letter of application:

- Never begin with ~~Dear Manager, Dear Director~~:
  use Dear Mr/Ms… or Dear Sir or Madame.
- Say why you're writing and where you saw the advertisement.
- Make sure you deal with all the points in the ad.
- Vary the expressions you use; For example, I can…, I believe I'm capable of…; … .
- Use a formal register, avoid conversational expressions.

****

You have seen this advertisement in an English-language newspaper.

International Student Fair

Fair requires staff

The International Student Fair helps people choose the right college or university, and we are looking for assistants for this year's Fair. Duties will include giving directions and offering advice.

✓ Do you like helping people?
✓ Do you have experience of choosing a place of study?
✓ Are you willing to work evenings?

If so, apply to the organiser, Ms Evie Ross, saying why you think you are suitable for the job.

Write your letter of application in 140-190 words in an appropriate style.

Writing · letter of application: your answer (140-190 words)

Apply to Ms Evie Ross for an assistant job at the International Student Fair.

Grammar Reference

FUTURE FORMS

Look at a-f and match them with uses 1-6.

a) I think I'll give skiing a try sometimes.
b) I will have graduated, I hope, by the end of this year.
c) I'm meeting my persona/ tutor on Wednesday.
d) I've already made up my mind I'm going to teach.
e) I'll be doing that for about a year.
f) My exams started on October 28th and they finish a week from now.

1) for a definite future arrangement with someone
2) for an action in progress in the future
3) for a decision about the future or a prediction based on evidence
4) for a prediction, something that's not certain or a sudden decision
5) for a future event fixed by a timetable or schedule
6) for something that will be finished before a particular time

Some sentences are correct, some aren't. Correct the mistakes. In some cases, more than one answer is possible.

1. On the ticket it says that my plane is arriving at 22.30 on Friday.
2. The new teacher is meeting the college students later today.
3. I would only like to travel in late June because I've just finished my course at that time.
4. I also know English and French quite well, which I believe are going to help me a great deal.
5. I'll tell you everything, with all the details, when we meet again.
6. I'm sorry but I can't do the course in August because I'll go camping with my friends then.
7. Visiting you in July is just perfect because the schools will have closed and I will already have sat my exams.
8. I need a new dictionary. I think I will have gone to Foyles Bookshop next Monday.

In pairs, ask and answer the questions using future forms. Use full sentences.
Example: Where / you spend / your summer holidays?
A: Where will you be spending (are you going to spend) your summer holidays?
B: I'll be spending (am going to spend) them at the seaside.

- When / you do / your homework?
- Who / you meet / next weekend?
- In which month / the next school term / start?
- By what age / you think / you / finished studying?
- How many children / you think / you have?
- Where / you probably work / ten years from now?

Future forms · answers

Some sentences are correct, some aren't. Correct the mistakes (write "correct" if there is none).

1. On the ticket it says that my plane is arriving at 22.30 on Friday.
2. The new teacher is meeting the college students later today.
3. I would only like to travel in late June because I've just finished my course at that time.
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Ask and answer the questions using future forms (full sentences).

1. When / you do / your homework?
2. Who / you meet / next weekend?
3. In which month / the next school term / start?
4. By what age / you think / you / finished studying?
5. How many children / you think / you have?
6. Where / you probably work / ten years from now?

Phrasal verbs – TAKE+…

Match these phrasal verbs with meanings 1-8.

take out	took to	taking on	take off
taken on	take in	taking over	took up

1) started doing (a job)
2) getting control of (a company)
3) employed
4) started to like
5) understand completely
6) obtain (from a bank or insurance company, for example)
7) suddenly start to be successful
8) accepting (a responsibility)

Complete the sentences with phrasal verbs. Use the correct form of *take* and a suitable adverb particle.

1. Now that exports have increased, the firm is going to _____ 100 more staff.
2. At first, I didn't really _____ the new boss, but I quite like her now.
3. When our company was _____ by a much bigger firm, some people lost their jobs.
4. Simon has _____ far too much work. He looks exhausted all the time.
5. Sales of our new product have really _____ since we began advertising it on TV.
6. We would like you to _____ the position of Assistant Manager from next month.
7. If you drive a car, you must _____ insurance in case you have an accident.
8. So much was new on my first day at work that it was hard to _____ everything _____